



UX Comparison Report

Manufacturing Cloud Forecasting & Planning vs. Market Competitors

A visual comparison of user experience across our solution and leading enterprise planning tools including Pigment, Anaplan, SAP, Oracle, and Workday.

Prepared: December 27, 2025

Type: UX-Focused Analysis with Screenshots

Executive Summary

Key UX Findings

Our solution demonstrates **strong UX fundamentals** with modern design patterns, but faces stiff competition from Pigment in the "modern UX" category. We excel in Salesforce ecosystem integration but have opportunities to improve in advanced interactions and polish.

UX Dimension	Our Solution	Pigment	Anaplan	SAP	Oracle
Visual Design	8.0	9.5	7.0	5.0	5.5
Grid Interaction	8.5	9.0	8.0	6.0	6.5
Navigation	8.0	8.5	7.0	5.0	5.0
Collaboration UX	8.5	9.0	6.5	4.5	5.0
Learning Curve	8.5	9.0	6.0	4.0	4.0
OVERALL UX SCORE	8.3	9.0	6.9	4.9	5.2

Our Solution: Visual Showcase

1. Full Grid View

Clean, modern grid layout with Salesforce Lightning Design System integration. Features hierarchical row expansion, time-based columns, and clear visual hierarchy.

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Manufacturing Cloud | Home Analytics Opportunities ▾ Leads ▾ Tasks ▾ Forecasting & Planning Accounts ▾ Contacts ▾ Dashboards ▾ More ▾

Planning & Forecasting FY26 ▾ Grid

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Search in Grid..

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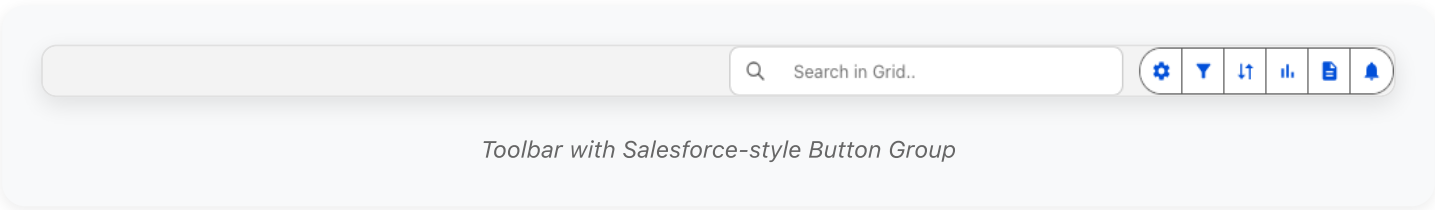
Measures / Dimensions x Time	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov
▾ Sales Agreement Quantity	800	800	800	800	800	800	800	800	800	800	800
▾ Magna Drive - Michigan Plan	800	800	800	800	800	800	800	800	800	800	800
▾ Transmission Assembly	400	400	400	400	400	400	400	400	400	400	400
TRN 750 - A	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80
TRN 750 - B	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80
TRN 750 - C	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80
TRN 750 - D	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80
TRN 750 - E	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80	80
▾ Chassis Components	400	400	400	400	400	400	400	400	400	400	400
Chassis Product 1	200	200	200	200	200	200	200	200	200	200	200
Chassis Product 2	200	200	200	200	200	200	200	200	200	200	200
▾ Sales Agreement Revenue	80,000	80,000	80,000	80,000	80,000	80,000	80,000	80,000	80,000	80,000	80,000
▾ Magna Drive - Michigan Plan	80,000	80,000	80,000	80,000	80,000	80,000	80,000	80,000	80,000	80,000	80,000
▾ Transmission Assembly	40,000	40,000	40,000	40,000	40,000	40,000	40,000	40,000	40,000	40,000	40,000

Manufacturing Cloud - Main Grid Interface

- ✓ **Clean Layout:** Uncluttered interface with clear visual hierarchy
- ✓ **Modern Typography:** SF Pro font family, consistent sizing
- ✓ **Light Background:** Easy on the eyes for long working sessions

2. Modern Button Group Toolbar

Pill-shaped button group with clear iconography and active state indicators. Blue icons on white background, reversing when active.



OUR SOLUTION

- Pill-shaped container with rounded ends
- Blue icons (#0250D9) on white
- Active state reverses colors
- Consistent 32px button size
- Dividers between buttons

COMPETITORS

- **Pigment:** Similar modern approach, custom icons
- **Anaplan:** Individual buttons, less cohesive
- **SAP:** Fiori icon bar, dated look
- **Oracle:** Ribbon-style toolbar, complex

3. Settings Panel (Slide-out)

Contextual slide-out panel that doesn't interrupt workflow. Clean form controls with proper spacing and grouping.

Manufacturing Cloud

HomeAnalyticsOpportunitiesLeadsTasksForecasting & PlanningAccountsContactsDashboardsMore

Planning & Forecasting FY26

Grid

Search in Grid..

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Measures / Dimensions x Time	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul
Sales Agreement Quantity	800	800	800	800	800	800	800
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Transmission Assembly	40,000	40,000	40,000	40,000	40,000	40,000	40,000

Table Settings

Measure, Dimension & Time Settings

Select LayoutMeasures / Dimensions x Time

Measure SubgroupRevenue and Quantity Measures

Reorder Measures

Dimension Levels3 Levels Selected

Time Granularity1 Level Selected

Display Settings

Row SettingsExpand All RowsCollapse All Rows

Column SettingsReset Column WidthReset Sort

Column Width1-10034

Settings Panel - Slide-out Design

✓ UX Advantage: Non-Modal Panels

Unlike SAP and Oracle which use modal dialogs that block the main interface, our slide-out panels allow users to see context while making changes. This is consistent with modern SaaS patterns used by Pigment and Notion.

4. Filters Panel

Dedicated filtering panel with product and time filter blocks. Each filter shows a summary and opens a multi-select popover on edit.

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Grid

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Transmission Assembly	40,000	40,000	40,000	40,000	40,000	40,000	40,000

< Filters

Measure Subgroup

Revenue and Quantity Measures

Dimension Levels

3 Levels Selected

Filter by Measures

5 Measures Selected

Filter by Account

Equals All

Filter by Category

Equals All

Filter by Products

Equals All

Filter by Time

Equals Jan 26 to Dec 26

Add Filter

Remove All

Filters Panel with Product and Time Filters

5. Cell Details & History Panel

Salesforce-inspired activity timeline showing edit history with threaded discussions. Each edit shows user, timestamp, value change, and adjustment notes.

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Planning & Forecasting FY26

Grid

Search in Grid...

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Cell Details and History

Single CellMulti-cell

Select a cell to know more

Cell Details and History - Salesforce Timeline Style

- ✓ **Activity Timeline:** Vertical connector line between events, like Salesforce
- ✓ **User Avatars:** Initials-based avatars with consistent styling
- ✓ **Threaded Discussions:** Reply directly to specific edits
- ✓ **Expand/Collapse:** Detailed info hidden until needed

6. Search with Real-time Highlighting

Instant search filtering across hierarchies with visual highlighting of matched text. Columns automatically filter to show only relevant time periods.

Manufacturing Cloud

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Planning & Forecasting FY26 > Grid

Planning & Forecasting FY26

may

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Measures / Dimensions x Time	May
Sales Agreement Quantity	800
Magna Drive - Michigan Plan	800
Transmission Assembly	400
TRN 750 - A	80
TRN 750 - B	80
TRN 750 - C	80
TRN 750 - D	80
TRN 750 - E	80
Chassis Components	400
Chassis Product 1	200
Chassis Product 2	200
Sales Agreement Revenue	80,000
Magna Drive - Michigan Plan	80,000
Transmission Assembly	40,000

Cell Details and History

Single CellMulti-cell

Select a cell to know more

Search for "may" - Instant Filtering & Highlighting

OUR SOLUTION

Real-time filtering as you type, yellow highlighting on matched text, hierarchical awareness (shows parents of matching children)



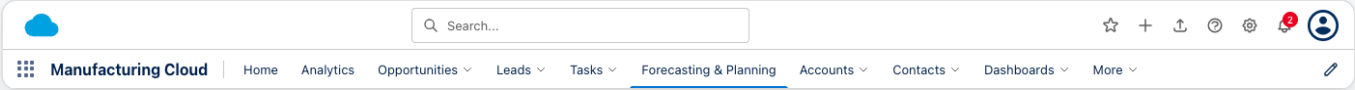
ANAPLAN / SAP / ORACLE

Basic search with filter buttons, no real-time highlighting, often requires clicking "Apply" button



7. Header Design

Two-row header matching Salesforce Lightning template with cloud logo, search bar, navigation tabs, and user icons.



Salesforce-style Two-Row Header

Competitor UX Analysis

Pigment - The UX Benchmark

Why Pigment Leads in UX

Pigment was founded in 2019 with a UX-first philosophy, specifically designed to disrupt legacy planning tools. Their interface takes inspiration from modern tools like Notion and Figma.

UX Strengths

- Pixel-perfect modern design
- Smooth animations and transitions
- Real-time collaboration (like Google Docs)
- Intuitive drag-and-drop modeling
- Dark mode support
- Keyboard shortcuts for power users

Where We Can Compete

- Salesforce-native integration (we win)
- Manufacturing-specific workflows
- Familiar UI for SF users
- Lower learning curve for SF ecosystem

UX Score: 9.0/10 - Sets the standard for modern planning UX

Anaplan - Enterprise Standard

Mature but Aging Interface

Anaplan has been around since 2006 and their interface shows its age. While functional, it prioritizes power over polish.

UX Strengths

- Powerful modeling interface
- Comprehensive dashboards
- Good keyboard navigation
- Robust export options

UX Weaknesses

- Cluttered interface
- Steep learning curve
- Modal-heavy interactions
- Dated visual design
- Complex navigation structure

UX Score: 6.9/10 - Functional but dated, prioritizes power over usability

SAP IBP / Analytics Cloud

Enterprise Complexity

SAP's planning tools inherit the complexity of the broader SAP ecosystem. While powerful, the UX is designed for trained administrators rather than business users.

UX Strengths

- Fiori design system (improving)
- Deep ERP integration
- Comprehensive functionality

UX Weaknesses

- Very steep learning curve
- Complex multi-screen workflows
- Overwhelming for new users

- Inconsistent UI patterns
- Heavy, slow-loading interfaces

UX Score: 4.9/10 - Power at the cost of usability

Oracle EPM Cloud

Legacy Meets Cloud

Oracle's EPM Cloud modernizes their Hyperion legacy but still carries enterprise complexity. The Redwood design system is improving things gradually.

UX Strengths

- Redwood design (newer, cleaner)
- Strong financial close UX
- Good reporting interfaces

UX Weaknesses

- Complex setup screens
- Multiple products, inconsistent UX
- Heavy admin interfaces
- Slow cloud performance

UX Score: 5.2/10 - Improving but still carries legacy weight

Feature-by-Feature UX Comparison

Grid Editing Experience

Capability	Our Solution	Pigment	Anaplan	SAP	Oracle
Inline cell editing	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	Partial	Partial
Tab/Arrow navigation	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	Limited	Limited
Undo/Redo	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	No	Limited
Copy/Paste multiple cells	Roadmap	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes
Cell-level comments	✓ Threaded	✓ Threaded	Basic	Attachments	Notes
Visual change indicator	✓ Dog-ear	✓ Dot	Color	None	Color

Navigation & Layout

Capability	Our Solution	Pigment	Anaplan	SAP	Oracle
Multiple grid layouts	3 Options	Flexible	Custom	Limited	Limited
Breadcrumb navigation	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	Partial	✓ Yes	✓ Yes
Slide-out panels	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	Modals	Pages	Pages
Real-time search	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	Basic	No	No
Search highlighting	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	No	No	No
Frozen headers	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes	✓ Yes

Visual Design Quality

Aspect	Our Solution	Pigment	Anaplan	SAP	Oracle
Design system	Salesforce Lightning	Custom Modern	Proprietary	SAP Fiori	Oracle Redwood
Typography	Excellent	Excellent	Good	Average	Average
Color palette	Modern Blue	Vibrant	Muted	Corporate	Corporate
Iconography	Consistent	Custom	Mixed	Fiori Icons	Mixed
Spacing/Layout	Well-spaced	Generous	Dense	Cramped	Dense
Animations	Basic	Smooth	Minimal	None	Minimal

Conclusions & Recommendations

Where We Excel

- **Salesforce Integration:** Native Lightning Design System - familiar to millions of SF users
- **Search Experience:** Real-time filtering with highlighting - better than Anaplan, SAP, Oracle
- **Collaboration UX:** Salesforce-style timeline with threaded discussions
- **Panel Design:** Modern slide-out panels vs. legacy modal dialogs
- **Button Group Toolbar:** Clean, modern interaction pattern
- **Learning Curve:** Much faster adoption than enterprise alternatives

Where We Can Improve

- **Animations:** Add smooth transitions like Pigment (expand/collapse, panel slides)
- **Dark Mode:** Pigment offers this, we don't yet
- **Keyboard Shortcuts:** Power user features for faster navigation
- **Multi-cell Operations:** Copy/paste across cell ranges
- **Visual Polish:** Micro-interactions, hover states, loading skeletons
- **Mobile/Responsive:** Better tablet and mobile experience

Final UX Ranking

Rank	Solution	Score	Best For
1	Pigment	9.0/10	Modern companies prioritizing UX
2	Our Solution	8.3/10	Salesforce ecosystem users
3	Workday Adaptive	7.5/10	Workday customers
4	Anaplan	6.9/10	Power users needing flexibility
5	Oracle EPM	5.2/10	Oracle ecosystem enterprises
6	SAP IBP	4.9/10	SAP-centric organizations

Bottom Line

Our solution delivers **strong UX that significantly outperforms legacy enterprise tools** (SAP, Oracle, Anaplan) while approaching—but not yet matching—the UX excellence of Pigment. Our key differentiator is native Salesforce integration, which provides a familiar experience for the millions of users already in the Salesforce ecosystem. With focused improvements in animations, keyboard shortcuts, and mobile responsiveness, we can further close the gap with Pigment.

UX Comparison Report - Manufacturing Cloud Forecasting & Planning
Screenshots captured December 2025 | Competitor analysis based on public demos and documentation